CHRIS **HICKMAN**

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SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 3+ years' experience building high-scale backend systems in Java and Spring Boot. Led revenue-impacting features for Walmart's Sparky AI and modernized mission-critical catalog services serving millions of events. Strong in distributed systems, Kafka, and performance optimization. Open to backend or full-stack roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

LANGUAGES

- Java (8, 11,17,21)
- Kotlin
- Python
- JavaScript

BACKEND:

- Spring Boot
- Kafka
- REST APIs
- Microservices

FRONTEND:

- React
- HTML
- CSS

MONITORING:

- Grafana
- Splunk

DEVOPS:

- CI/CD
- Kubernetes
- Jenkins
- Maven, Gradle

CLOUD AND DATA:

- Azure CosmosDB
- GCP (BigQuery, AlloyDB)
- PostgreSQL

SOFTWARE & DESIGN TOOLS:

- IntelliJ IDEA
- Postman
- Git

EXPERIENCE

APRIL 2025 – PRESENT

SOFTWARE ENGINEER – SPARKY AI WALMART EMERGING TECH, HOBOKEN NJ

Java engineer enhancing Walmart's AI shopping experience Sparky. Utilizing Java 21 Spring-Boot/Maven in an agentic environment to ship features. Leading Sparky's efforts to provide agent-based experience for online retail.

- Led end-to-end engineering for the **Essentials Experience**, from design through production release, improving customer access to high-frequency everyday items and directly driving increased GMV.
- Led **Sparky Ads integration** for Sparky's product search, enabling monetized product recommendations and generating meaningful incremental revenue through partner brands (exact figures confidential).
- Drove **engineering excellence initiatives** focused on scalable microservice architecture, maintainability, and production readiness in an ecommerce environment used by over 1M+ monthly customers.

FEBRUARY 2023 – APRIL 2025

SOFTWARE ENGINEER – CATALOG WALMART GLOBAL TECH, HOBOKEN NJ

Enhanced and maintained Walmart's product setup pipeline, ensuring accurate product matching and catalog integrity. Built and optimized scalable, high-performance systems critical to product setup, including Matching and Normalization.

- **Designed and optimized RESTful APIs**, improving data retrieval efficiency and system reliability. Modernized mission-critical Product Merge and Split APIs, by leading a zero-downtime migration from Java 8 to Java 21. Leveraged Spring Boot 3.x and Virtual Threads to optimize concurrency, resulting in a 40% reduction in p99 latency for high-volume catalog transactions.
- **Built and maintained Kafka-based microservices**, streamlining product data processing and reducing consumer lag.
- **Designed Spark jobs in PySpark**, processing millions of messages from Kafka and integrating with GCP storage solutions.
- **Led improvements in product matching systems**, enhancing data normalization and catalog accuracy for billions of products.

SEPTEMBER 2021 – DECEMBER 2022

TARS RESEARCH INTERN, THE TERASCALE ALL-SENSING RESEARCH STUDIO

- Coordinated collection of data and user experience for a virtual classroom environment. Emphasis on HCI. Environment was developed in Unity.

EDUCATION

2021 – 2022

BS COMPUTER SCIENCE, CLARKSON UNIVERSITY POTSDAM, NY

- Strong foundation in algorithms, software design, and OOP (Java, C++).
- Graduated with great distinction, GPA: 3.86

AAS GRAPHIC ART AND DESIGN, NCCC

- Mastered design principles, UI/UX concepts, and the Adobe Suite.